On 4 June 1947, Mountbatten announced 15 August 1947 as the deadline for the transfer of power, instead of sticking to the earlier target date of 30 June 1948.[10] Why did Mountbatten spring this surprise? Mountbatten was a shrewd man and there was no way that he could have not known that his Chief of Staff, 'Pug' Ismay had a different viewpoint. Did the advancement of the date for the transfer of power have anything to do with Ismay's planning for an alternative plan to give Pakistan control of Kashmir rather than India?

For Mountbatten, there remained the complex problem of the future intentions of the two big states of Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad, which had indicated an interest in being an independent state after Partition. Mountbatten made it abundantly clear that he was personally unhappy about the prospect of independence for either. On 9 June 1947, he announced that he was instructing the British residents in both states to urge the rulers to make no announcements about independence until he had had the opportunity to visit them and discuss the matter.

Mountbatten, accompanied by Lady Mountbatten and Lord Ismay, arrived in Srinagar on 17 June 1947 and was back in New Delhi six days later. During these crucial six days, his aim was to engage in detailed parleys with Hari Singh and Kak. Mountbatten asked Nehru to prepare an exhaustive briefing note on Kashmir for him that would provide him with talking points for the ensuing discussions. While in Srinagar, Mountbatten was frustrated because Hari Singh was unwilling to engage in any serious discussions with him; the Maharaja had picked up the gossip about Nehru's friendship with Edwina Mountbatten and his extraordinary closeness to the couple while Jinnah was kept at arm's length by the Mountbattens. To Hari Singh, Lord Mountbatten was merely a votary of Nehru's views on the future of the state. He did not allow Mountbatten to visit Sheikh Abdullah in prison, even with Nehru's intervention. Lady Mountbatten found it impracticable to meet Begum Abdullah and Mountbatten made no attempt to visit another of the Maharaja's political prisoners, Chaudhry Ghulam Abbas, or to seek the views of the Mirwaiz. He did, however, engage with Kak. Mountbatten is believed to have said to Kak that the state of Jammu